

What causes it?

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- Type 2 diabetes is caused by a combination of insulin resistance/insensitivity (where the body is unable to respond to normal levels of insulin) and insulin deficiency (where the pancreas is unable to secrete enough insulin to compensate for this resistance) [Mayer-Davis, 2018 (</topics/diabetes-type-2/references/>)] [Zeitler, 2018 (</topics/diabetes-type-2/references/>)].
 - People with type 2 diabetes can differ in the balance of importance of increased insulin resistance and decreased insulin secretion that contributes to their disease, and both mechanisms may co-exist.
 - Insulin resistance may be exacerbated by obesity, physical inactivity, and other risk factors (</topics/diabetes-type-2/background-information/risk-factors/>).

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